



What comes *next*? 1, 1, 2, 3, 5,



If you're stuck on the puzzle above, here's a clue: try adding. This famous series of numbers was found by Leonardo Fibonacci of Pisa, in Italy, 800 years ago. It crops up in the most surprising places.

Nature's NUMBERS

If rabbits breed for a year, how many pairs will there be?

1



1



2



3



5



Breeding like rabbits

Fibonacci thought up a puzzle about rabbits. Suppose the following. You start with two babies, which take a month to grow up and then start mating. Females give birth a month after mating, there are two babies in each litter, and no rabbits die. How many pairs will there be after a year? The answer is the 13th number in the Fibonacci series: 233.

Count the petals

The number of petals in a flower is often a number from the Fibonacci sequence. Michaelmas daisies, for instance, usually have either 34, 55, or 89 petals.

